

Yafira Martinez

Design Engineer / Creative Technologist

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Interactive Systems, Interfaces & Experimental Technologies

SKILLS

Front-End Development: React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Node.js, REST APIs, Web Serial, p5.js, ml5.js, Creative Coding, Supabase, Vercel, Git

Design: Interaction Design, UX/UI, Responsive Web Design, Design Systems, Prototyping, GenAI Tools, Wireframing, Digital Accessibility, Information Architecture, User Research, Figma, Adobe Suite

Hardware: Physical Computing, Microcontrollers (Arduino, Raspberry Pi, ESP32, RP2040, Adafruit), CircuitPython, Python, Fritzing, E-Textiles, Soft Circuits, Wearables, Soldering, Fabrication (laser cutting, 3D printing, knitting machine)

EXPERIENCE

Design Engineer & Creative Technologist — Electrocutelab

Mar 2021 – Present

Creative independent practice

- Design and ship independent web applications and tools end to end — electrocute-ui, a React component library with an 18-color design token system published to npm, and tinytinker.tools, an open-source maker toolkit of 22+ browser tools — alongside maker tutorials, open workshop materials, and project documentation on a technical blog (Astro + TinaCMS).
- Work at the intersection of textile craft and computation — soft circuits, e-textiles, physical computing, and generative text — with projects exhibited at venues including the Open Hardware Summit in Berlin and taught in public workshops.

Lead Camp Counselor — ITP Camp, New York University

Jun 2026

Previously: Camp Counselor, Jun 2025

- Led a 150+ person creative technology community through workshops, mentorship, and hands-on support across hardware, software, and fabrication.
- Designed and built spot-mapper, a real-time collaborative floor-plan mapping tool (Leaflet, Vercel serverless functions, Redis, token-based auth) used live during the Show All Things Show, with admin/viewer roles, mobile support, and full handoff documentation.

Hardware Research Developer — NYU Ability Lab

Oct 2025 – May 2026

- Researched accessible fashion technologies for the Making Fashion Accessible project, using knitting machines and AYAB (open-source knitting machine software) to support inclusive, open-source garment production and adaptable textile workflows.

Graduate Teaching & Research Assistant — NYU ITP/IMA

Sep 2025 – May 2026

- Graduate Teaching Assistant for Creative Computing (Prof. Daniel Shiffman) and Intro to Wearables (Instructor Daniel Ryan Johnston), mentoring students in creative coding and wearable design; Research Assistant for Computational Text, developing syllabus material spanning procedural text, data ethics, and machine learning.
- Designing a Teachable Machines workshop — ml5.js + p5.js image-classification games — to be co-led for ~60 middle school students with NYU's College & Career Lab (upcoming, Jul 2026).

Machine Learning Researcher & Web Contributor — ml5.js

Jun 2025 – May 2026

Mentors: Daniel Shiffman & J.H. Moon

- Researched and prototyped ml5.transcribe() and ml5.embeddings(), bringing browser-based transformer models (Whisper, Moonshine) to a library designed for students, artists, and beginner coders.
- Refined interaction design and inference performance, and contributed documentation and examples to support contributor and learner usability.

Web Developer & Designer — Useless Machines Archive, NYU

Mar 2025 – Aug 2025

Professor: Blair Simmons

- Designed and built a front-end web archive using the Are.na API, focusing on client-side data fetching, content organization, and responsive interface design.

Lead Web Developer — Equitable Syllabus Project, NYU ITP/IMA

Nov 2024 – May 2026

- Redesigned and rebuilt the project website with accessible, user-centered interfaces — from Figma designs to a production Next.js deployment — while migrating project data and maintaining centralized contribution tracking.

Software Engineer & Creative Technologist Intern — Floreo Labs

Jan 2020 – May 2020

- Developed responsive front-end applications in React and designed UI/UX prototypes in Adobe XD; contributed to mobile projects while managing agile workflows and producing technical documentation.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Master of Professional Studies (MPS), Interactive Telecommunications Program

May 2026

New York University, Tisch School of the Arts

Bachelor of Science (BS), Computer Science

Dec 2020

City University of New York, Lehman College

Certifications: Artificial Intelligence, Samsung Innovation Campus (2022–2023) · Human Computer Interaction, Interaction Design Foundation (2022) · Google UX Design, Coursera (2021)

SELECTED WORK & EXPLORATIONS

- Soft Circuit Boards (SCBs) Workshop — ITP Camp, NYU** Jun 2026
Designed and taught a hands-on workshop on handmade circuits — copper tape traces, craft foam boards, and LEDs, no soldering required — extending work from the Soft Circuit Library.
- PetalByte — Bring Your Own Data (BYOD), NY Tech Week by a16z, NYC** Jun 2026
Portable generative text device treating the USB drive as both archive and interface; Markov chain corpora live on a flower-shaped laser-cut acrylic enclosure, browsable through a custom pygame interface on a Raspberry Pi touchscreen.
- The Soft Computer Mini — Open Hardware Summit, Berlin** May 2026
Travel-ready extension of The Soft Computer, exploring embodied input, generative text, and textile as substrate, compressed into a tarot-sized device.
- The Soft Computer — Periphery: ITP Thesis Show, NYC Resistor** May 2026
Textile-based computing interface combining machine-knit wool, capacitive fabric inputs, haptics, and a flexible e-ink display; Raspberry Pi 5 drives Markov chain text generation across four corpus-mapped channels.
- Open Hardware Summit Fellow — Open Source Hardware Association, Berlin** Feb 2026 – Jun 2026
Selected fellow exhibiting The Soft Computer and other experimental open-source hardware projects at the Open Hardware Summit, Berlin.
- Soft Circuit Library — Electronics Faire (Theme: Repair), Temple University Libraries** Apr 2026
Collection of handmade textile circuit boards organized as a living archive, each designed to be handled, studied, and repaired by touch.
- Guardians of the Groceries — Best of Software, PlayfulNYC Hackathon** Apr 2026
Awarded Best of Software. Built the hardware and software layer of a handheld ESP32 device that captures photos, uploads to Supabase via WiFi, and pairs with a live web registry documenting NYC bodega cats.
- Pocket Oracle of Time — Horological Society of New York** Feb – Apr 2026
Poetic timekeeping object exploring ritual, slowness, and material interaction with time through embedded electronics and tactile design.
- Enoki — MIT Media Lab AI x Hardware Hackathon** Mar 2026
Focus companion for communal accountability: a React Native app using Mentra smart glasses and Claude Vision AI paired with a Raspberry Pi desktop device that visualizes focus as a mushroom that grows when on task and wilts when distracted.
- Moon Pocket — Pedestal Playtime: Art Toy & Tech Toy Open Mic, NYC Resistor** Jan 2026
Connected device (Arduino Nano 33 IoT) that fetches real-time moon and tide data from public web APIs and renders it on a round TFT display through touch-based interaction.
- Tendertronics — NYU ITP NIME Show, Littlefield** Dec 2025
Analog instrument performance exploring tactile, minimal interfaces and embodied sound interaction through handcrafted circuitry.
- Lightning Talk Speaker — Exploring Creativity in the Age of AI, NYU Global Show & Tell** Oct 2025
Presented "Open Tools, Soft Interfaces" on ml5.js contributions and framing creativity in AI through openness, design as dialogue, and soft, human-centered interfaces.
- Static Chic — Volt Couture: Wearables + E-textiles Open Mic, NYC Resistor** May 2025
3D-printed inductive handbag with an embedded coil that wirelessly powers and lights up LEDs, presented at an open mic curated by Kari Love and Liza Stark.
- MIT Reality Hack — Massachusetts Institute of Technology** Jan 2025
Implemented sound and haptic feedback for HangarPro VR, a virtual reality training simulation using Cognitive3D for pre-flight safety.